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Pulkovo customs officers stop the illegal import of a shipment of live lobsters

Pulkovo customs officers found 107 chilled crustaceans in the luggage of a passenger arriving from the United Arab Emirates.

The man was transporting the arthropods in special foam boxes lined with plastic. He said he was bringing the lobsters for himself and planned to keep the exotic animals in his swimming pool. However, he did not have the required transport permits. The man later admitted that the seafood delicacies were expected at a restaurant in Moscow.

Inspectors sent the lobsters for examination to identify the species and determine their value on the domestic market of the Russian Federation. Experts identified the goods as “live lobsters in shells, from the lobster family, genus Homarinus”. A comparable shipment of this delicacy costs nearly 700,000 rubles in Russia.

Two administrative offence cases have been opened: one under Part 1 of Article 16.2 of the Code of Administrative Offences of the Russian Federation (failure to declare goods), and one under Article 16.3 (failure to comply with prohibitions and/or restrictions on the export of goods). The courts will make the final decision in the case.

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